As for the impetuses behind the foray to Tiginabad/Old Qandahar in the first place, and the Shansabani presence documentable there: it is not unimaginable that, with Ghaznavid power gradually declining in the region – particularly after 'Ala' al-Din's much touted destruction of Ghazna itself and Bust-Lashkari Bazar – the Firuzkuh Shansabanis attempted to revive Tiginabad/Old Qandahar as a commercially and strategically pivotal emporium once again. After all, the eastward transit routes from Herat skirting Ghur to the south, passing through Tiginabad/Old Qandahar upon entering and exiting India, continued to be just as viable as their northern counterparts.

As with Bamiyan and the slate of new politico-military contenders and rivals appearing on the horizon by the twelfth century (see above), Tiginabad again proved itself a strategic point of military operations: the Oghüz occupation of Ghazna signified yet another (nomadic) enemy in the region certainly for the Firuzkuh Shansabanis, whom Shihab al-Din – though subordinate to his older brother Shams al-Din, titled Ghiyath al-Din as of AH 558/1163 CE – had nonetheless persistently tried to dislodge throughout the 1160s. But it was only through a joint effort of *both* brothers that the Oghüz were finally routed; as a result, the Firuzkuh-based Shansabanis could claim definitive occupation of the erstwhile Yamini capital in AH 569/1173–1174 CE (after prior brief stints there by 'Ala' al-Din Husain – cf. Chapter 1). This victory accrued to the younger Shihab al-Din, who was finally crowned sultan, receiving the surely long-awaited title of Sultan Mu'izz al-Din (cf. also Chapters 4 and 5). Tiginabad/Old Qandahar likely served a strategic purpose for the Firuzkuh Shansabanis, then, but barring rediscovery of additional evidence, it appears that Shansabani presence there left behind only burials of a very few, albeit seemingly important personages.[95] It is, of course, quite possible that the continuing lifestyle of transhumance of this branch of the Shansabani clan might have left other, less conventional archaeological traces in the material record, recovery of which would require surveying and even excavating afresh at the historical city and in its vicinity.[96]

Multiple Shansabani Imperial Architectures

Compared with the available documentation of Ghur's built remains (cf. Chapter 2), the more extensive archaeological explorations of the Bamiyan basin as well as Tiginabad/Old Qandahar permit several overarching observations. There are noteworthy material and historiographical parallels between the Shansabanis' appanages in Ghur, Bamiyan, and al-Rukkhaj-Zamindawar. The core areas of Bamiyan and Firuzkuh were in fact central nodes in the discernibly differing cultural and economic geographies of eastern and western Afghanistan, while the Ghazna–Tiginabad/